GUESS for Infrastructure and Transportation

Networks on maps, hubs and bridges, robustness to failure and attack, routes by hops and by distance, regional systems, with two worked case studies

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Why networks?

Airlines, railways, roads, power grids, pipelines and the internet are networks you can point to on a map. What the network view adds is how the parts depend on each other:

- Which places are hubs, and which are the bridges whose loss would cut regions off?
- How does the system degrade when parts fail at random, or are attacked?
- What is the best route by number of hops, and by distance?
- What regional systems does the network break into?

This book assumes the Kitchen for loading, querying and drawing. Its data are in the cookbooks' `data` folder:

file	what it is
`us-airports.gdf`	549 airports in the United States and the 2,787 airport pairs with scheduled domestic service. `weight` is the number of airline routes listed between the two. Node fields: `iata` (code), `city`, `latitude`, `longitude`, `airport` (name).
`world-airports.gdf`	The same for the whole world: 3,257 airports and 18,930 pairs, with `country`.

Both come from the OpenFlights airport and route databases (Open Database License), a 2014 snapshot. They record which routes exist, not how often they're flown or how many seats they carry, so a twice-weekly island hop counts the same as a shuttle.

Networks on maps

Put a network on a map Basic

You have nodes with latitude and longitude. **You want** them where they are, on a map.

Ingredients: `us-airports.gdf` · `geoLayout`

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
geoLayout(projection="albers")
sizeBy(degree, 3, 30)
colorBy(degree, lightgray, red)
hubs = sortBy(degree)[-12:]
hubs.labelvisible = true
g.edges.color = "150,150,150,40"
```

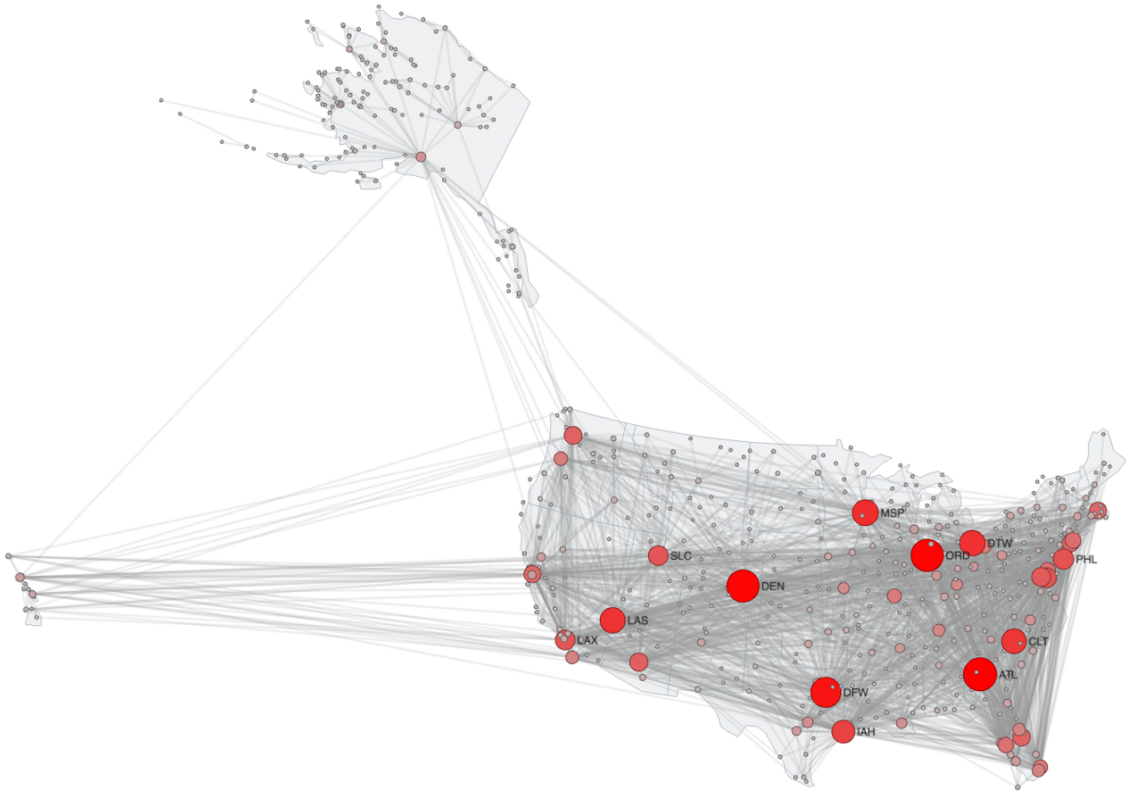


Figure 1: US domestic air routes on an Albers projection

How it works. `geoLayout()` finds the `latitude` and `longitude` fields (or `lat`/`lon`; name them if yours differ), projects each node, and draws a map underneath: the states when every node is in the United States, the world's coastlines otherwise. Its choice of projection matters:

projection	keeps	use for
`"mercator"` (default)	local shapes and directions	world maps, web-map habits
`"albers"`	areas; shapes good in mid-latitudes	countries and continents; the US by default (`parallels=`, `center=` for others)

projection	keeps	use for
`"equirectangular"`	nothing in particular, but simple	quick looks, data already in degrees

The map is drawn as vector outlines (Natural Earth, public domain). It stays sharp at any zoom, follows the light or dark theme (or `land=`/`borders=` colours), and is included in SVG and PDF exports. `removeMap()` removes it.

Pitfalls. The Albers projection tuned for the lower 48 states puts Alaska and Hawaii where they really are, so the map is wide and mostly ocean. Published US maps move them into insets. If that matters, open the lower 48 as a graph of its own, `subgraph((longitude > -130) & (latitude < 50))`, then run `geoLayout` again. Alaska gets the same treatment in the first case study.

A world network Basic

```
makeFromGDF("world-airports.gdf")
geoLayout()
sizeBy(degree, 2, 24)
colorBy(betweenness, lightgray, red, scale="log")
g.edges.visible = false
```

How it works. With 3,257 airports, the routes would cover the map, so this recipe hides them and lets size (number of routes) and colour (how often an airport lies on the shortest connections between others) carry the story. The busiest airports by routes are European: Amsterdam, Frankfurt, Paris and Istanbul, then Atlanta. By betweenness the list changes to Paris, Los Angeles, Anchorage, Dubai and Frankfurt. These are the connectors between world regions.

Draw flows, not lines Intermediate

You want the big corridors of a network to stand out from the clutter of individual edges.

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
subgraph((longitude > -130) & (latitude < 50), "lower 48")
geoLayout(projection="albers")
sizeBy(degree, 2, 20)
g.edges.color = "40,70,140,50"
bundleEdges()
```



Figure 2: Lower-48 routes, bundled into corridors

How it works. `subgraph` keeps the lower 48 states' airports and the routes among them, and running `geoLayout` again fits the map to them. `bundleEdges()` gathers edges that run alike into shared bundles, which turns a hairball of routes into a flow map: the transcontinental corridors, the north–south spines along each coast, and the fans around each hub (*Kitchen: Outline groups and bundle the hairball*). `method="fdeb"` gives smoother, more organic curves. `unbundleEdges()` goes back to straight lines.

Pitfalls. Bundling distorts geography on purpose: a bundled edge no longer shows the route it takes. Use it to show where flows concentrate, and draw individual routes straight when the route itself matters.

Hubs, bridges and weak points

Hubs are not the same as bridges Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
for n in sortBy(degree)[-5:]: print(n.iata, n.city, n.degree,
 ↪  round(n.betweenness))
for n in sortBy(betweenness)[-5:]: print(n.iata, n.city, n.degree,
 ↪  round(n.betweenness))
```

How it works. The airports with the most routes (Atlanta, Chicago O'Hare, Denver, Dallas–Fort Worth, Minneapolis) are hubs. The airport on the most shortest paths is Anchorage, with only 34 routes. Most of Alaska's airports can reach the rest of the country only through it, so every journey between them and the lower 48 passes through one place. That's a bridge, and it's the more fragile kind of importance: other hubs can substitute for Atlanta, but nothing can substitute for Anchorage.

Find the weak points Basic

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
geoLayout(projection="albers")
cuts = cutNodes()
cuts.color = red
cuts.size = 12
bridges().color = red
len(cuts), len(bridges())
```

How it works. A *cut node* is one whose loss disconnects part of the network (60 airports here), and a *bridge* is an edge whose loss does the same (165 routes). Most of them are small: a regional airport that is the only link for a still smaller one. A few, like Anchorage, hold up whole regions. Sort the cut nodes by how much they'd strand (next recipe) to tell them apart.

What if a hub closes? Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
geoLayout(projection="albers")
ss("open")
remove(ANC)
recompute()
colorize(component)
g.edges.color = "150,150,150,60"
len(giantComponent()), len(component.distinct)
```

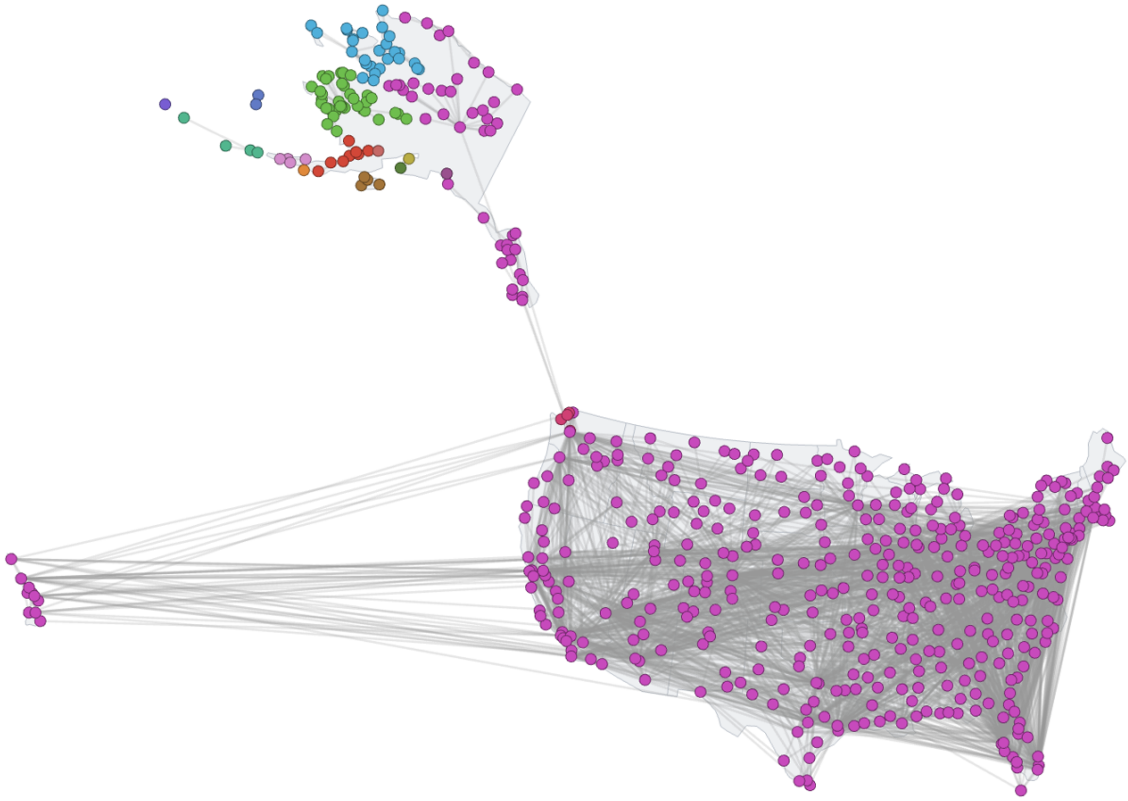


Figure 3: Without Anchorage, Alaska falls into pieces

How it works. `ss("open")` saves the network, `remove(ANC)` closes Anchorage, and `recompute()` refreshes computed fields such as `component` (*SNA: the Medici case study*). Colouring by component shows what's left. Eight airports were already off the main network (two small island systems), and closing Anchorage cuts off 87 more, in 12 new pieces, nearly all in Alaska. Closing Atlanta, the busiest hub, strands eleven. `ls("open")` reopens it, and `morph("open", 1500)` animates the difference.

Robustness

Failures versus attacks Intermediate

You want to know how the network degrades as parts fail: by accident (at random), or by targeted attack on its most important parts.

Ingredients: `us-airports.gdf` · `robustness`

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
r = robustness(["random", "degree", "betweenness", "adaptive"])
```

How it works. `robustness()` removes nodes in each given order and records the share of nodes still in the largest connected piece after each removal. It plots the curves and leaves the graph untouched. The orders are:

order	removes first	models
`"random"`	random nodes (averaged over `trials`)	failures, weather, accidents
`"degree"`	the nodes with the most links	an attack on the hubs
`"betweenness"`	the nodes on the most shortest paths	an attack on the bridges
`"adaptive"`	the current biggest hub, re-ranked after each removal	a determined attacker
a node field	the highest values of that field	any priority: age, cost, risk

The US airline network loses half its largest piece only after 34% of airports fail at random. An attack on the hubs does it with 6%, and an attack on the bridges with 3%. This *robust yet fragile* pattern is typical of networks with hubs. Random failures mostly hit small airports that nothing depends on, while a few removals in the right places split the system. The world network is similar (37% at random, 8% by degree).

Pitfalls. Connectivity isn't capacity. A network can stay connected while its remaining hubs are overloaded, so simulate load (or use `maxFlow`) when capacity matters. In this data, "connected" also counts a weekly flight the same as a shuttle.

Routes

Fewest hops or shortest distance? Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
geoDistance()
hops = shortestPath(BRW, MIA)
[n.iata for n in hops if n in g.nodes], round(sum(e.km for e in hops if e in
 ↪  g.edges))
for e in g.edges: e.weight = e.km
short = shortestPath(BRW, MIA, weighted=true)
[n.iata for n in short if n in g.nodes], round(sum(e.km for e in short if e in
 ↪  g.edges))
```

How it works. `geoDistance()` stores each route's great-circle length in kilometres, as the edge field `km`. `shortestPath` counts hops by default. With `weighted=true` it uses each edge's `weight` as a length, so copying `km` into `weight` gives the shortest route by distance. From Utqiaġvik (Barrow), Alaska, to Miami, both answers take three flights through Anchorage, but by fewest hops the route goes via Los Angeles (8,696 km), while the shortest by distance goes via Minneapolis (7,623 km). The longest domestic route in the data is Honolulu–New York JFK, 8,007 km.

Variations. `spanningTree()` gives the fewest edges that keep everything connected (with `weight` as cost, the cheapest network). `maxFlow(a, b)` and `minCut(a, b)` give how many separate routes join two places, and which few routes' loss would separate them.

Regional systems

Find the regional systems Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
geoLayout(projection="albers")
louvainClusters()
colorize(modularity_class)
for grp in groupBy(modularity_class)[:6]:
    top = sortBy(grp, degree)[-3:]
    print(len(grp), [n.iata for n in top])
```

How it works. Communities in a transport network are regions served mostly from within. Here they follow the airlines' hub systems more than the map: the East around Atlanta, Charlotte and Detroit; Texas around Dallas–Fort Worth; the Mountain West and the Pacific coast around Denver and Las Vegas; the Midwest around Chicago and Minneapolis; and two Alaskan systems, one around Anchorage and one in the southeast around Juneau. On the map the communities overlap, because a hub's reach is continental.

Case studies

Case study: Alaska's single point of failure Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("us-airports.gdf")
alaska = (latitude > 51) & (longitude < -129)
len(alaska)
subgraph(alaska, "Alaska")
geoLayout(projection="albers", parallels=(55, 65), center=(-154, 60))
sizeBy(betweenness, 3, 30)
labelBy(iata)
```

Alaska has 135 airports with scheduled service, a quarter of the country's, and few roads between them, so the air network *is* the transport network. `subgraph` opens Alaska's airports and routes on their own, and `geoLayout` with Alaskan parallels draws them in proportion. Sized by betweenness, the structure is a hub and spokes of spokes: Anchorage at the centre, and regional hubs (Bethel, Fairbanks, Nome, Kotzebue, and Juneau in the southeast) each serving their own villages. `cutN-`

`odes()` finds 22 airports in Alaska whose loss would strand somebody, and Anchorage would strand nearly everyone. Back in the national network, `robustness("betweenness")` removes Anchorage first, which is why the bridge attack does so much damage so quickly.

Case study: hubs of the world Intermediate

```
makeFromGDF("world-airports.gdf")
geoLayout()
top_routes = sortBy(degree)[-10:]
top_bridges = sortBy(betweenness)[-10:]
[n.iata for n in top_routes], [n.iata for n in top_bridges]
(top_routes & top_bridges)
```

Six airports are on both top-ten lists (Amsterdam, Frankfurt, Paris, Istanbul, Chicago O'Hare and Beijing): the great hubs both have many routes and join regions. The other four on each list tell different stories. By routes they are Atlanta, Dallas–Fort Worth, Munich and Moscow Domodedovo, with many routes mostly within their own region. By betweenness they are Anchorage and Los Angeles across the Pacific, Dubai between Europe, Africa and Asia, and Toronto, which join continents with comparatively few routes. A planner asking "which airports matter most?" needs both lists: the first for traffic, the second for keeping regions connected at all.